National Transportation Safety Board
Aviation Accident Final Report

Location:	Blue Bell, PA	**Accident Number:**	NYC08CA066
Date & Time:	12/20/2007, 0820 EST	**Registration:**	N4814L
Aircraft:	Piper PA28-180	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:		**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General Aviation - Instructional		

Analysis

The solo student pilot of the Piper PA28 stated that he applied left rudder to compensate for a "slight" left crosswind while on approach to land on Runway 06. At touchdown, having "never let off left rudder," the airplane departed the left side of the runway and struck a culvert and two signs. A post flight inspection revealed damage to the propeller, nose landing gear, and firewall. The student pilot reported 78 total hours of flight experience, 31 hours in make and model, and reported no deficiencies with the performance and handling of the airplane. At the time of the accident, the winds reported at the airport were from 280 degrees at 3 knots.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be: The student pilot's failure to maintain directional control while landing.

Findings

Occurrence #1: LOSS OF CONTROL - ON GROUND/WATER
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
1. (C) DIRECTIONAL CONTROL - NOT MAINTAINED - PILOT IN COMMAND

Occurrence #2: ON GROUND/WATER COLLISION WITH OBJECT
Phase of Operation: LANDING - ROLL

Findings
2. OBJECT - AIRPORT SIGN/MARKER
3. TERRAIN CONDITION - DITCH

Factual Information

Student Pilot Information

Certificate:	Student	**Age:**	47, Male
Airplane Rating(s):	None	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	Seatbelt, Shoulder harness
Instrument Rating(s):	None	**Second Pilot Present:**	
Instructor Rating(s):		**Toxicology Performed:**	No
Medical Certification:	Class 3	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	
Occupational Pilot:		**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	
Flight Time:	78 hours (Total, all aircraft), 31 hours (Total, this make and model), 31 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft), 31 hours (Last 30 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Piper	**Registration:**	N4814L
Model/Series:	PA28-180	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:		**Amateur Built:**	No
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	28-4154
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	05/01/2007, Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	
Time Since Last Inspection:	79 Hours	**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	3075 Hours at time of accident	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Lycoming
ELT:	Installed, not activated	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-360
Registered Owner:	Norman M. McAvoy	**Rated Power:**	
Operator:	Norman M. McAvoy	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual Conditions	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KLOM, 302 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	
Observation Time:	0820 EST	**Direction from Accident Site:**	
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	5 Miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	3 knots /	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	280°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.16 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	1°C / -2°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Blue Bell, PA (KLOM)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	Company VFR
Destination:	(KLOM)	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	0800 EST	**Type of Airspace:**	

Airport Information

Airport:	Wings Field (LOM)	**Runway Surface Type:**	
Airport Elevation:		**Runway Surface Condition:**	
Runway Used:	6	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:		**VFR Approach/Landing:**	

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	40.134444, -75.276389

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Brian C Rayner	**Report Date:**	04/30/2008
Additional Participating Persons:	Art Brownwell; Philadelphia, PA		
Publish Date:			
Note:	This accident report documents the factual circumstances of this accident as described to the NTSB.		
Investigation Docket:	NTSB accident and incident dockets serve as permanent archival information for the NTSB's investigations. Dockets released prior to June 1, 2009 are publicly available from the NTSB's Record Management Division at pubinq@ntsb.gov, or at 800-877-6799. Dockets released after this date are available at http://dms.ntsb.gov/pubdms/.		

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB), established in 1967, is an independent federal agency mandated by Congress through the Independent Safety Board Act of 1974 to investigate transportation accidents, determine the probable causes of the accidents, issue safety recommendations, study transportation safety issues, and evaluate the safety effectiveness of government agencies involved in transportation. The NTSB makes public its actions and decisions through accident reports, safety studies, special investigation reports, safety recommendations, and statistical reviews.

The Independent Safety Board Act, as codified at 49 U.S.C. Section 1154(b), precludes the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an incident or accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report. A factual report that may be admissible under 49 U.S.C. § 1154(b) is available here.